

In the previous lesson, we introduced the concept of dasein. It's the being aware of being.

Let's recap the existentials. Dasein is aware of being and could be seen as a potential being, a *sein können*. The human being is the being having multiple possibilities to exist, unlike other living beings that are satisfied within their instincts, human life tends to take another direction ("*sensus*"), aimed at giving a meaning through its life. What is proper to dasein, is not only the biological living, but also the *ek-sistere*, that is not just "staying", but trying to play with temporality and possibilities, because we're trying to play beyond the present, through our project. However, the possibilities that are available for a dasein are not unlimited. We've the "thrownness", which limits the range of possibilities a specific dasein can access, depending on when and where someone is born, the historical context, etc.

Our initial possibilities do not necessarily determine our destiny. Starting from this condition of thrownness, each person can elaborate their existential project, and impress a meaning on it.

The other existential we've discussed is "being in the world". We encounter the world by experiencing it, thus coming into contact with it. Contacting the world is important, as the senses in general constitute the way we've access to what surrounds us.

We're able to understand the world by sensing it.

What we encounter might be an entity, or another dasein.

Speaking about entities, object we encounter in the environment, we said that the first look we give to them, is to consider them as possible tools, instruments, something that may serve us, available and ready to hand.

These two concepts have a name in Heidegger philosophy, and they're known as "*vorhandenheit*" and "*zuhandenheit*". "*heit*" is "-icity". "*handen*" stands for the "hand". *vorhandenheit* means that something is at our disposition, and *zuhandenheit* means that something is ready to hand. Disposition comes from latin "*dispositio*", which has two different but connect meanings. To dispose something, means to order it, displace it, and organize things with a purpose in mind. It also means to have something ready to hand.

Heidegger describes nowadays world (that is composed) as a *Gestell*. It's used to

divide the purpose of things in the world. It's also a Bestand, that is a stock, pantry. Both of these are connected to vorhandenheit and zuhandenheit.

We've seen that the world should not be intended simply as a determined place, but also as a set of meanings that form the background of our everyday life. Entities, as they enter the human gaze, they become tools. Heidegger names this situation (gaze over things) the "Um-sicht". In this idea, these things are connected through a chain of reference.

Example: when we see a nail, we refer it to a hammer. They're down for hanging a painting. Hanging a painting is down for making an House nicer, and this is down for the dasein.

Everytime, the end of the chain is given by the dasein.

This chain eventually stops when it reaches the dasein. What is the dasein for, then? Dasein is not referred to anything else, being self-referential. Once we've found the central point where all these references gather, we must look at it closely for Heidegger.

What is the dasein then? It's the only being who poses questions about being. Heidegger does not simply provide an answer, but tries to show what sense makes posing this question again.

We may say the dasein it's me, but what do we mean by "me"? What definition of me has settled in our way of thinking and interpreting the world? Heidegger answers this question, dismantling the philosophical tradition. He criticised the idea of subject, subject like something that lies behind, considered to be a stable structure opposed to the mutability of its manifestation.

How does Heidegger do that? He reverse the terms of the problem. The subject was considered first to be this stable structure while he kept changing. By reversing the problem, instead of forcing the mutability of the human being into a disembodied, a temporal, he starts precisely from this stable instability in order to define the human essence.

According to another tradition, the me is the result of "cogito ergo sum". The risk of this approach, however, is that the subejct may assume that he is something that really isn't, especially if the subject is not aware that is way of thinking is influenced by its pre-understanding.

After rejecting these interpretations, Heidegger tries to present the dasein not providing descriptions, but trying to describe the phenomenon of existence.

Existence is characterised, from the very beginning, from the presence of things and other. These two moments cannot be considered separated. Dasein, getting in contact with tools, perceive the presence of other dasein through the world.

The world of dasein is a world that is shared with other. For 9 months, we even

share the body of another person.

Heidegger asks how are these others? Are they really "others" to me?

The others does not mean those who remain after I remove myself, rather are those...

*In italian: In questo caso non significa coloro che restano dopo che mi sono tolto, gli altri sono quelli dai quali non ci si distingue, e fra i quali si è anche.*

Even if a dasein is a being with ("mit-sein"), can also live alone. Heidegger replies that Heidegger is a being with even when others are not present or perceived.

Being alone is a modality of being with others in the world. The others can be absent with respect of the idea of being with others. This mode of being with others without the others is called "deficient".

The actual loneliness does not disappear simply because another member of humans come closer. No matter how many people can gather around him, a dasein could still feel alone in a crowd. Thus, we're not with others but among others. In this mode of indifference, being with others takes the form of "co-presence". Simple presence characterised the entities aware of being. The way that dasein relates to entities is different from how it relates to another dasein.

When a dasein encounter an entity, he tries to procure certain things that may be useful for him, or takes care of entities ("besorgen"). He manipulates his things in order to use them.

When its regarded to other people, dasein does not take care of them, rather have care of them ("fursorge").

As we've seen with the mit-sein, having a deficient mode.

... not caring about others.

There are two positive ways of taking care of others. The first one is when, instead of having care of others, we take care of them, treating them of entities (taking over their care). In this case, caring can relieve the other, but by stepping into their space the other are displaced and reduced to decisions they've should have taken themselves. Their project is substituted by a programs decided by others.

Think about how artificial intelligence is now taking care of us...

Taking care does not help others to become themselves, rather to become myself, sustituting their project with mine. This kind of care creates dynamics of dependence and domination. There are moments in which we must take care of others, like when they're young, old, sick, therefore needing somebody of taking care of them.

This is part of the fact that we're being inserted in a temporality, so we're not stable subjects, but we pass through different stages of dasein.

The other way of caring for others, opposite to the first, does not aim to replace the other, but to return, restore his possibilities. Here I care for the other, and commit myself so that the other become themselves. I do not relieve them of their responsibilities, like problems and challenges they must deal with by being in the world.

The characteristics of authentic care for others are respect ("rucksicht") and indulgence ("nachsicht"). "sicht" means "sight". "rucksicht" means that, when there is a situation, we make a step back. as for the "nachsicht", it's a glance that comes closer, indulgent with others.

My presence is thus not aimed at substitution, but at restoration. What is restored for the others in this form of care? The possibility of being transparent and free in imagining their project.

The most elementary and close knowledge of others require that we get to know them, not merely knowing them. When mutual knowledge is lost in form of dissimulation (when we pretend not be hungry we dissimulate), ...

Being together requires a special procedure to approach to others, like for example Psychology.

We also have a critique of the concept of empathy, Heidegger states that the possibility of understanding another person don't derive from the capacity of projecting into someone else life, rather comes from the interest (coming from "inter-esse", which means "to be inside"). We share the same existential condition, thus we're interested in others, by observing them we can build up our project, being inspired by others.

It makes no sense to speak of empathy, as dasein already has an understanding of its own being. Starting from this, he understands the others.

It's easy to observe that relating to others is not simple, being not just the projection into another of who we are. While I understand the other starting from myself, I do not do it completely. How can the other be understandable to me then, when I'm myself and not him?

There cannot be a plural dasein, who is always a singular, even when being with others. When dasein is treated as a plural, the other become numbers. In this being together, that according to Heidegger is disrespectful, others are numbers we can count, but not count on them, having nothing to do with them. When others become numbers, we can either count or not count on them.

Heidegger now points out that being with other has problems too. What are the problems? The gaze must return to dasein, starting from the idea that he is also a "being with others". Although others deliver the world to us when they're born,

the values, the presence of others arouses in us a double concern, and this is that of distinguishing myself from them. On one hand, I fear distinguishing myself, thus feeling like I feel different, not "belonging" to them. I belong to others in the meaning that I have the perception of being part of a community. There is also a second meaning, belonging like being a property of others. This concern can also take the form of denying every difference, or striving to return at the level of others, conforming with them.

We want to affirm our uniqueness when we want to distinguish ourselves.

In being together, the concern to be or not to be like others dominates. Heidegger calls this condition "comparative measurement".

Being with others in every day life is also in a state of subjection to them. Others relieve me of my choices, taken away from me now.

What if I move and change the others I'm dealing with? While the other are not specific others, they're interchangeable, they're simply those who're here in my existence, but if they're replaced with other others it will not change my position of subjection to them.

In this indistinct plurality, where others exist in a state of indistinction, the dictatorship of "das man" takes root (dittatura del "si-", tipo "si dice", "si fa").

The "man" is not anyone, and also someone. "Das man" is the neutral, the impersonal ("one think", "one believes", etc.).

Heidegger describes this dictatorship as "we have fun as one have fun, we read and judge literature as one does that", etc.

Another name for this is the "averageness", creating a dictatorship.

Every attempt to exist, going out and standing, is dissolved immediately in what is already known. Every great achievement becomes banalized in it's narration.

What becomes public and average, is obscured in its essence.

The voice of a common person seems to be everywhere, yet there is a moment where it disappears, the moment of decision.

Even if common thinking does not help in this moment, since it has anticipated our judgement and choices, it relieves the dasein of individual responsibility, and tells "the man did what had to be done".

Responsibility means the ability to justify what one has done. The "man" removes this burden, satisfying it's natural tendency to take everything lightly, making it easy.

By doing this, the "man" is welcome by every individual dasein, maintaining its

domination.

The more massively this dictatorship, the more elusive it becomes.

Precisely as Heidegger does not see dasein as a subject, but as something dynamic, saying that even if das man is existential and belongs to dasein, it's not a permanent quality, and the strenght of its dominion can change (?).

The "se stesso" (myself) that when enters in the mediality becomes il "si stesso", that belongs others, is every different from my authentic self ("proprio se stesso"), belonging not to others but to himself.

We have eigentlichkeit and un-eigentlichkeit. "eigen" has different meanings, like "property". So, eigentlichkeit is what is appropriate to me, not for everyone but for me solely.